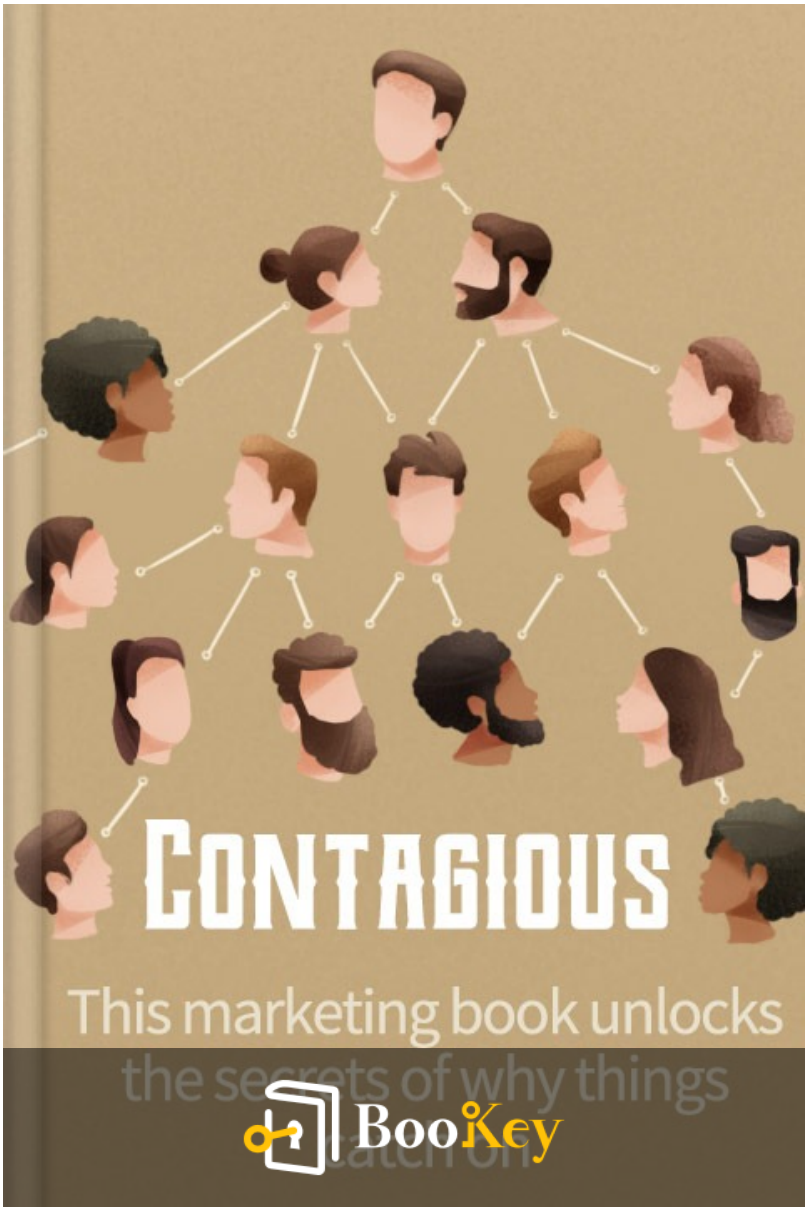
Contagious PDF

Jonah Berger



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Contagious

Unlocking the Secrets of Viral Ideas and Popularity.

Written by Bookey

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About the book

"Contagious: How to Make Ideas Viral" by Jonah Berger delves into the intriguing science behind why certain products, stories, and ideas capture public attention and spread like wildfire. Drawing on a decade of research as a Wharton marketing professor, Berger uncovers the six fundamental principles that drive word-of-mouth and social transmission, offering compelling insights into the mechanisms of virality. From the unexpected success of a luxury steakhouse linked to a humble cheese-steak to the counterproductive effects of anti-drug ads, Berger expertly illustrates how social influence shapes our choices and behaviors. Filled with actionable strategies for crafting messages that resonate and ignite conversation, this New York Times bestseller equips marketers, business owners, and communicators with the tools to make their ideas contagious, ensuring they reach a broader audience and spark meaningful engagement.

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About the author

Jonah Berger is a renowned marketing professor and behavioral scientist known for his research on the dynamics of social influence and the secrets behind why certain ideas and products become popular. A faculty member at the Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania, Berger has contributed significant insights into the fields of consumer behavior and marketing through his innovative studies and engaging publications. His acclaimed book, "Contagious: How to Make Products and Ideas Catch On," explores the mechanisms that drive word-of-mouth and viral marketing, presenting practical strategies for creating compelling narratives that resonate with audiences. Berger's work has not only garnered scholarly acclaim but has also been embraced by business leaders and entrepreneurs seeking to harness the power of social transmission in their ventures.

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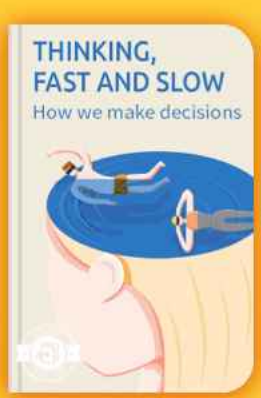
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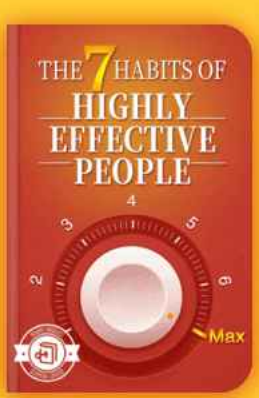
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Summary Content List

Chapter1 : Social Currency

Chapter2 : Triggers

Chapter3 : Emotion

Chapter4 : Public

Chapter5 : Practical Value

Chapter6 : Stories

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Chapter1 Summary : Social Currency

SUMMARY OF CHAPTER 1 – "Contagious" by Jonah Berger

Introduction to Crif Dogs

- Brian Shebairo and Chris Antista opened **Crif Dogs** in NYC after two years of research. They aimed to replicate New Jersey's famous hot dog experiences.

The Challenge of Expansion

- Over time, Brian sought to open a bar by utilizing the adjacent empty space from a failing bubble tea lounge. This took three years of negotiations.

Creating Please Don’t Tell

- To stand out among numerous bars in NYC, Brian transformed a 1930s phone booth into the entrance of a secret

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bar called
Please Don’t Tell
. Its unique access point and lack of advertisement created intrigue.

The Power of Secrets

- The allure of secrets increases word-of-mouth communication as people love to share insider information, as seen with
Please Don’t Tell
which thrives on personal recommendations rather than traditional marketing.

Social Currency Explained

- Information that enhances one's self-image is shared frequently. People enjoy sharing personal stories as it releases rewards in the brain, making them feel good.

Inner Remarkability

- Remarkable products capture attention and are shared. An example is

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Snapple
, which included surprising facts under its caps, leading to wide sharing.

Creating Engaging Content

- Companies can drive engagement by identifying what makes their product interesting or unusual. This can lead to the creation of "viral" knowledge or experiences people want to share.

Leverage Game Mechanics

- People enjoy competition and achievements, exemplified by frequent flier programs that offer status symbols like elite tiers, influencing customers to promote brands through personal achievements.

Fostering a Sense of Exclusivity

- Businesses can enhance desirability through exclusivity, making customers feel like insiders. The success of
Rue La La
, a private sale site, showcases how exclusivity and urgency

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can drive word-of-mouth.

Scarcity and Insidership

- Scarcity and exclusivity not only boost interest but create emotional attachments—making customers not only value a product more but also inclined to share their experiences.

Conclusion: Keys to Making Ideas Contagious

- Achieving a successful word-of-mouth strategy involves creating social currency by enhancing remarkability, leveraging competitive game mechanics, and fostering feelings of exclusivity among customers, all while capitalizing on the power of hidden experiences.

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Chapter2 Summary : Triggers

SUMMARY OF CHAPTER 2 FROM "CONTAGIOUS" BY JONAH BERGER

The Role of Triggers in Word-of-Mouth

The chapter discusses the concept of "triggers," which are stimuli in the environment that elevate the likelihood of products and ideas being talked about. Contrary to the belief that only interesting or exciting products garner word of mouth, the evidence indicates that triggers play a crucial role in fostering conversations.

Dave Balter and BzzAgent

Dave Balter, founder of BzzAgent, emphasizes that marketing should focus on consumers' genuine enthusiasm rather than coercing them to buy unnecessary products. BzzAgent connects brands with a network of individuals (BzzAgents) who willingly share their experiences with products, leading to organic word of mouth.

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The Nature of Word-of-Mouth Conversations

Average Americans engage in numerous conversations about brands daily without being conscious of it. People naturally discuss products, brands, and services based on what's relevant in their lives.

Differences Between Immediate and Ongoing Word-of-Mouth

The chapter differentiates between immediate word of mouth, triggered right after an event, and ongoing word of mouth, which can continue for weeks or months. Interesting products may generate immediate buzz, but they do not sustain ongoing conversations in the same way.

Understanding Triggers

Triggers are environmental cues that keep thoughts about products top of mind, leading to increased likelihood of purchasing or talking about them. For instance, regularly consumed products, like Ziploc bags or Cheerios, benefit from constant reminders, which boost their buzz.

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Rebecca Black's "Friday" and Viral Success

The case of Rebecca Black's song "Friday" serves as an example of how consistent stimuli can lead to viral success. The song's name prompted regular search spikes on Fridays, proving that being top of mind often correlates with accessibility.

Creating Effective Triggers

Effective triggers are frequent and relevant to the desired behavior. The chapter highlights that triggers should be well-timed and situated in environments where people can easily recall and act on them.

Habitats for Products

Like animals need specific habitats, products and ideas thrive in environments filled with relevant triggers. The chapter shares how Kit Kat successfully became associated with coffee, turning the beverage into a frequent trigger that reminded consumers of the candy bar.

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Learning from Campaigns and Context

Successful campaigns consider context and environmental triggers. The effectiveness of health or public service messages can hinge on how well they align with consumers' daily routines and decision-making scenarios.

Conclusion: The Power of Top-of-Mind Thinking

In summary, triggers are vital for sustaining word-of-mouth. While social currency may spark interest, triggers ensure products remain at the forefront of consumers' minds. Understanding how to create and leverage triggers enables brands to significantly enhance their visibility and success in the market.

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Chapter3 Summary : Emotion



Summary of Chapter 3: Emotion and Sharing

Notable Experiment in Chemistry

Grady, a science writer, became captivated by an experiment that involved using metal electrodes to manipulate falling droplets. This thrill led her to a career in science journalism, with a goal to evoke similar excitement in readers about scientific discoveries.

Grady's Viral Article

Grady's article, which explored how a professor used

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photography to capture the dynamics of a human cough, gained unexpected virality despite its technical nature. The emotional impact of the visuals in the article contributed significantly to its widespread sharing.

Analysis of Viral Content

Research revealed that articles with high emotional resonance were more likely to be shared. The study analyzed thousands of New York Times articles, identifying that emotionally charged content triggered more sharing.

Factors Influencing Sharing

Articles deemed interesting and useful were often shared more frequently. However, the standout element was the evocation of awe, a powerful emotion that drove readers to spread the content. Scientific articles in particular frequently

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Chapter4 Summary : Public

SUMMARY OF CHAPTER 4: OBSERVABILITY AND SOCIAL PROOF

The Importance of Observability in Branding

- Steve Jobs focused on how the Apple logo should be oriented when users open their laptops. Initially, it faced the user when closed, but Jobs realized that visibility mattered more for branding. Changing the orientation meant that when laptops were in use, the logo would be observable to others, driving brand awareness.

The Psychology of Imitation

- Humans often look to others for cues on behavior when making choices. Social proof plays a significant role in decision-making. For example, people are more likely to choose busy restaurants, vote if their spouse does, or conform to what their peers do. This desire to imitate is based on the assumption that others have more accurate information.

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Social Proof in Various Contexts

- People tend to imitate behaviors based on what they observe, leading to decisions influenced by the visible actions of others—like choosing a popular dish at a restaurant or participating in voting. Social proof affects behaviors even in critical situations, such as kidney transplants, where people may decline offers assuming they are of lower quality based on previous rejections.

Case Studies of Social Proof

- Various examples illustrate the concept of social proof. In NYC, long lines at a food cart imply better food quality. Similarly, MBA students gravitate towards stable career choices influenced heavily by their peers, highlighting the power of social influence in career decisions.

The Role of Visibility in Social Behavior

- To make products or ideas catch on, they must be observable. Koreen Johannessen, working on binge drinking at the University of Arizona, discovered that when students

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realized most of their peers drank moderately, they were less likely to binge. This indicates how making private behaviors public can reshape perceptions.

Creating Public Observability

- Public awareness can be enhanced by designing products that naturally promote themselves. For instance, Hotmail’s automatic signature in emails served as a constant advertisement, leading to rapid growth and adoption. Similarly, products displaying iconic features (like Apple’s white headphones) become more observable, influencing others.

Behavioral Residue as a Marketing Tool

- Marketing strategies can include creating 'behavioral residue', such as wristbands that visibly promote support for causes. The Livestrong wristband became successful largely due to its noticeable color and the social connections it fostered, promoting ongoing awareness.

Making the Private Public

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- Successful campaigns create public signals around private behaviors, such as encouraging everyday social discussions about issues like men's health through visible participation in events like Movember. This approach not only raises awareness but also enhances community participation.

When Publicity Can Backfire

- Making certain behaviors observable can also have negative effects, such as anti-drug campaigns inadvertently increasing drug use by highlighting its prevalence. A focus on social proof regarding negative behaviors can encourage imitation rather than deterrence.

Conclusion: The Dual Nature of Observability

- To effectively promote products or ideas, they must be made observable and embraced publicly. However, marketers should be cautious about amplifying less desirable behaviors. Creating visibility fosters social proof, driving engagement and encouraging imitation where beneficial.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The Role of Social Proof in Decision-Making

Critical Interpretation:Jonah Berger emphasizes the critical influence of social proof on consumer behavior, suggesting that people often look to others to guide their choices. While this dynamic indeed showcases how human behavior is socially constructed, one must critically evaluate whether such a reliance on social observation leads to genuine preferences or merely reflects herd mentality. Supporting literature, such as Cialdini's "Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion," argues that while social proof can drive engagement, it may simultaneously suppress individual decision-making skills and authenticity in consumer interests.

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Chapter5 Summary : Practical Value

Summary of Chapter 5: Practical Value

Introduction to Practical Value

In this chapter, Jonah Berger explores how practical value drives people to share information. He highlights the example of Ken Craig's viral corn-cleaning video that gained over 5 million views, particularly among older audiences, and unpacks the motivations behind why individuals readily share practical and useful information.

The Importance of Practical Value

People enjoy sharing practical, useful information, as it offers "news others can use." Sharing helpful advice strengthens social bonds and reflects positively on the sharer. Berger compares this sharing behavior to community barn raising, emphasizing a desire to assist and provide value to others.

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Factors Influencing Sharing Practical Value

1.
Savings and Discounts:
People are more inclined to share information that helps save time or money. For instance, promotions and discounts attract attention, especially if the offer appears as an exceptional deal.
2.
Psychology of Deals:
Behavioral economics reveals that people assess offers relative to reference points. A discount seems more appealing when it appears generous against an expected price, underscoring the role of framing and presentation of deals.

Diminishing Sensitivity

Berger introduces the concept of diminishing sensitivity, noting that the importance of a financial gain decreases as the purchase price increases. This helps explain why consumers prioritize savings on lower-priced items more than substantial savings on more expensive products.

Highlighting Incredible Value

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To share deals effectively, they must be framed in ways that exceed expectations while ensuring scarcity through restrictions enhances the perceived value. Clever pricing strategies, alongside the “Rule of 100,” help frame discounts properly, emphasizing how low prices stand out when presented contextually.

Visibility of Practical Value

For practical value to be contagious, it needs to be conspicuously visible. By making savings and discounts more apparent to shoppers, businesses can generate buzz around their promotions, potentially increasing demand through the visibility of benefits.

Broader and Narrow Audiences

Sharing decisions also hinge on the audience. While broader, more universally appealing content might seem likely to be shared more, narrow content that resonates with specific friendships tends to elicit more emotional reactions and prompt sharing.

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The Challenge of Truth

The chapter concludes with a caution on the dissemination of practical value. Even well-meaning intentions can lead to the spread of misinformation, emphasizing the importance of checking facts before forwarding information.

Conclusion

Ultimately, Berger emphasizes that knowing how to convey practical value is crucial for effective communication and sharing, leading to greater engagement and product appreciation. By tapping into the human desire to help others, individuals and companies can leverage practical value to enhance the shareability of their ideas and products.

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Example

Key Point:The power of sharing practical information.

Example:Imagine you just discovered a 90% off coupon for your favorite coffee shop. You can't wait to tell your friends about it, not just to save them money but because it feels good to help them enjoy their favorite drink at a fraction of the cost. Knowing the coupon is limited time, you share it broadly, impacting your friends' day positively. This act strengthens your social ties, as your friends are grateful and feel a connection to your generosity. This moments demonstrates how practical value motivates sharing and creates community.

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Chapter6 Summary : Stories

Section	Summary
Importance of Narratives	Stories, like the Trojan Horse, illustrate that trust can be misleading, emphasizing the importance of caution. They allow for deeper lessons to be absorbed more effectively than mere facts, as people relate to narratives more than data.
Stories as a Form of Entertainment	Historically, stories were primary sources of entertainment, engaging audiences with structured plots. Today, personal stories shared in social interactions convey social currency and emotion.
Stories as Vessels for Information	Stories convey valuable information through engaging plots, similar to classic fables with moral lessons. Personal anecdotes can also provide practical insights along with entertainment.
Cultural Learning Through Stories	Stories facilitate cultural transmission, imparting societal norms and values quickly and engagingly, allowing individuals to learn from others' experiences without extensive trial and error.
Engagement through Relatability	Personal stories resonate with audiences more than advertisements due to relatable elements, offering both entertainment and valuable information that can indirectly promote brands.
Creating Viral Narratives	Embedding valuable messages in captivating stories is crucial for promoting products, as seen in Dove's "Evolution" film, which effectively communicated the brand's values through an emotional narrative.
Making Virality Valuable	While virality is important, it is critical that stories remain relevant to the brand, ensuring audiences remember the associated product. The balance between entertainment and relevance is vital for lasting impressions.
Lessons from Examples	Case studies show the difference between entertaining stunts lacking brand connection and effective campaigns that authentically weave the product into the narrative.
Crafting Your Own Trojan Horse	To generate word of mouth, craft stories that act as Trojan Horses, seamlessly embedding the core message in an entertaining narrative for memorable impact.

THE POWER OF STORIES

Importance of Narratives

The Trojan Horse story illustrates a deeper lesson: trust can

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be deceiving, emphasizing the need for caution toward seemingly friendly intentions. Using stories allows for significant lessons to be absorbed more thoroughly than mere facts, reinforcing the idea that people think in narratives rather than data.

Stories as a Form of Entertainment

In ancient times, stories like the Trojan Horse and The Odyssey served as the primary entertainment. Narratives engage audiences because they encompass a structured beginning, middle, and end, making them enthralling and memorable. Even today, people share personal stories during social interactions, often using experiences to convey social currency, emotion, or practical value.

Stories as Vessels for Information

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Best Quotes from Contagious by Jonah Berger with Page Numbers

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Chapter1 | Quotes From Pages 27-49

1. The most powerful marketing is personal recommendation," he said.
2. If something is supposed to be secret, people might well be more likely to talk about it.
3. Self-sharing follows us throughout our lives.
4. People share things that make them look good to others.
5. The best thing about remarkability is that it can be applied to anything.
6. Scarcity is about how much of something is offered.

Chapter2 | Quotes From Pages 50-73

1. To Dave, marketing isn't about trying to convince people to purchase things they don't want or need. Marketing is about tapping into their genuine enthusiasm for products and services that they find useful. Or fun. Or beautiful. Marketing is

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about spreading the love.

2. But here's how BzzAgent works. Those who agree get a kit in the mail containing information about the product and coupons or a free trial. Participants in the Sonicare campaign, for example, received a free toothbrush and ten-dollar mail-in rebates for additional toothbrushes to give to others.
3. We suggest restaurants to coworkers, tell family members about a great sale, and recommend responsible babysitters to neighbors. American consumers mention specific brands more than 3 billion times a day. This kind of social talk is almost like breathing.
4. The more the desired behavior happens after a delay, the more important being triggered becomes. Market research often focuses on consumers' immediate reaction to an advertising message or campaign. But in most cases, people hear an ad one day and then go to the store days or weeks later.
5. Triggers help explain why Cheerios get more word of

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mouth than Disney World. True, Disney World is interesting and exciting. But the problem is that people don’t think about it very frequently.

Chapter3 | Quotes From Pages 74-97

1. When we care, we share.
2. Awe is the sense of wonder and amazement that occurs when someone is inspired by great knowledge, beauty, sublimity, or might.
3. Emotionally arousing content or experiences would be more likely to be shared.
4. People don’t want to feel like they’re being told something—they want to be entertained, they want to be moved.
5. Simply adding more arousal to a story or ad can have a big impact on people’s willingness to share it.
6. The best results don’t show up in a search engine, they show up in people’s lives.

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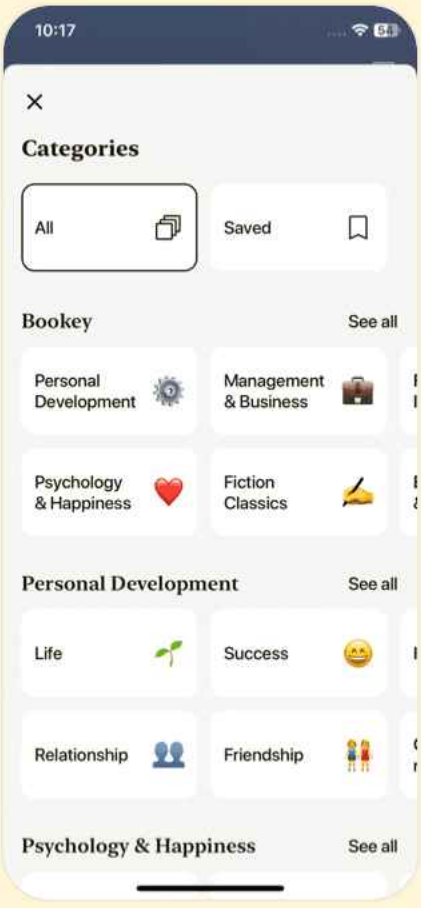
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Chapter4 | Quotes From Pages 98-119

1. Jobs realized that seeing others do something makes people more likely to do it themselves.
2. The famous phrase ‘Monkey see, monkey do’ captures more than just the human penchant for imitation.
3. If something is built to show, it’s built to grow.
4. Because behavior is public and thoughts are private.
5. Making the private public is particularly important for things that people may not have originally felt comfortable talking about.
6. Our basic hypothesis is that the more kids saw these ads, the more they came to believe that lots of other kids were using marijuana.
7. It’s hard to know how well the ride across America would have done if Nike had implemented it. And it’s easy to Monday-morning-quarterback a successful strategy...
8. If people can’t see what others are choosing and doing, they can’t imitate them.

Chapter5 | Quotes From Pages 120-136

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1. People like to pass along practical, useful information. News others can use.
2. Practical advice is shareable advice.
3. People share practically valuable information to help others.
4. The harder part is cutting through the clutter. There are lots of good restaurants and helpful websites, so we need to make our product or idea stand out.
5. We care about others and we want to make their lives better.

Chapter6 | Quotes From Pages 137-153

1. Beware of Greeks bearing gifts.
2. By encasing the lesson in a story, these early writers ensured that it would be passed along—and perhaps even be believed more wholeheartedly than if the lesson's words were spoken simply and plainly.
3. Stories are the original form of entertainment.
4. Just like the Trojan Horse itself, stories are more than they seem.

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5. Stories, then, can act as vessels, carriers that help transmit information to others.
6. The key, then, is to not only make something viral, but also make it valuable to the sponsoring company or organization.
7. If people don’t connect the content back to you, it’s not going to help you very much.

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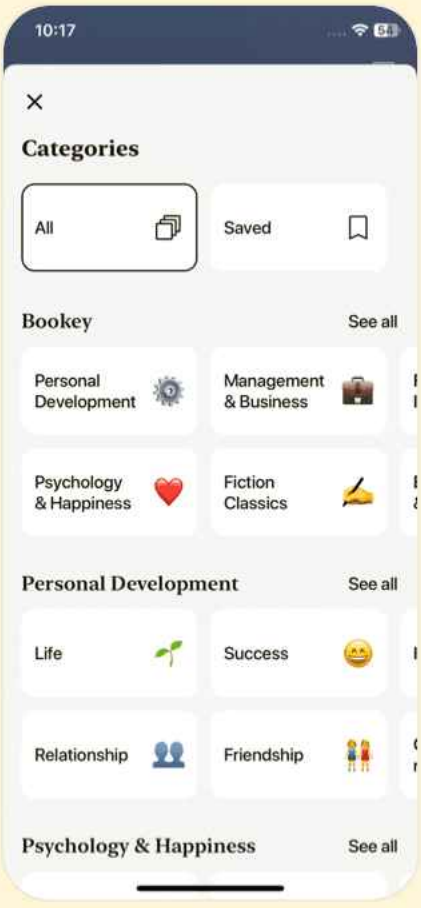
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Contagious Questions

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Chapter1 | Social Currency| Q&A

1.Question

What led Brian Shebairo and Chris Antista to start the hot dog business?

Answer:Brian and Chris were inspired by their childhood experiences in New Jersey, where they enjoyed eating hot dogs from famous places like Rutt’s Hut and Johnny & Hanges. They wanted to recreate that same experience in New York City.

2.Question

How did Please Don't Tell differentiate itself from other bars in New York?

Answer:Please Don't Tell carved out its niche by being a secret bar accessed through a hidden phone booth in a hot dog diner, creating a sense of exclusivity and discovery that attracted customers without traditional advertising.

3.Question

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What is 'social currency' and why is it important for word-of-mouth marketing?

Answer:Social currency refers to the value that people gain when they share information that makes them appear smart, cool, or in-the-know. This drives them to talk about brands or experiences that bolster their social image, thereby promoting those brands through word-of-mouth.

4.Question

What can businesses learn from Snapp's marketing strategy?

Answer:Businesses can learn that providing surprising and entertaining content (like Snapple's fun facts under caps) can encourage sharing and discussions. Remarkable experiences or products generate conversation and keep customers engaged.

5.Question

Why do people prefer to share experiences that make them look good?

Answer:People naturally prefer to share things that depict

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them in a positive light because it enhances their social image and provides a sense of validation and approval from others. Sharing entertaining or extraordinary stories increases their social currency.

6.Question

How does scarcity and exclusivity create desire among consumers?

Answer:Scarcity and exclusivity make certain products or experiences seem more valuable and desirable. When something is not readily available, people are more likely to talk about it and seek it out, motivated by a fear of missing out.

7.Question

What effective techniques can brands use to generate word-of-mouth?

Answer:Brands can mint social currency by finding inner remarkability in their offerings, leveraging game mechanics to motivate participation and engagement, and making customers feel like insiders through exclusivity.

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8.Question

Can social incentives be more effective than monetary incentives for motivation?

Answer:Yes, social incentives can be more effective in the long term because they promote intrinsic motivation. When people engage in behaviors for social approval rather than monetary rewards, they are often more committed to sharing their experiences.

9.Question

In what way did the concept of game mechanics apply to frequent flyer programs?

Answer:Frequent flyer programs utilize game mechanics by providing tangible goals (like earning miles and achieving status) that motivate loyalty and engagement among travelers, creating a competitive atmosphere that enhances word-of-mouth.

10.Question

What is the overall takeaway about how businesses can encourage customers to share their experiences?

Answer:Businesses should focus on creating remarkable

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experiences, fostering social connections, and ensuring their products or services provide social currency, which incentivizes customers to share and promote their brand.

Chapter2 | Triggers| Q&A

1.Question

What key argument does Jonah Berger present about triggers in word-of-mouth marketing?

Answer:Triggers play a crucial role in marketing because they make products more top of mind, encouraging more conversations about them. Unlike interesting products that may generate immediate buzz, it's often mundane items that get discussed consistently over time because they are frequently triggered by everyday activities.

2.Question

Can you explain why Cheerios gets more word of mouth than Disney World according to the chapter?

Answer:Cheerios is consumed daily and seen frequently in stores, resulting in regular triggers that keep it top of mind.

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In contrast, Disney World is visited infrequently, which means there are fewer triggers to elicit conversations about it.

3.Question

How did BzzAgent utilize triggers to increase product visibility?

Answer:BzzAgent identified specific demographic groups likely to discuss products based on their lifestyles and used triggers from their daily routines to increase word of mouth about the items they promoted.

4.Question

What distinguishes immediate word of mouth from ongoing word of mouth?

Answer:Immediate word of mouth occurs right after an experience, such as sharing details about an event shortly after attending. Ongoing word of mouth refers to discussions that happen over a longer period, engaging in conversations that reflect back on previous experiences.

5.Question

What does Berger mean when he states 'Top of mind means tip of tongue'?

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Answer:This phrase emphasizes that when certain thoughts or ideas are easily accessible and frequently triggered, they are more likely to be mentioned in conversation, thereby increasing word of mouth.

6.Question

Why might negative publicity still have a positive effect on sales, according to Berger?

Answer:Negative attention can serve as a trigger that keeps a product top of mind, leading to increased awareness and potentially boosting sales despite the negativity.

7.Question

How did the collaboration between Kit Kat and coffee work as a successful marketing strategy?

Answer:The campaign linked Kit Kat with coffee, a product frequently consumed, which acted as a trigger throughout the day, reminding consumers of Kit Kat whenever they had coffee, ultimately boosting its sales.

8.Question

What lessons should marketers take from the examples of triggers discussed in this chapter?

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Answer:Marketers should consider the context and environment where their products are consumed. They should design marketing strategies that create new associations and triggers that remind consumers about their products at the right moments.

9.Question

How does the concept of habitats relate to products and ideas?

Answer:Just as animals thrive in natural habitats defined by specific environmental elements, products have 'habitats' composed of triggers that cause people to think about and engage with them. These habitats can be expanded by forming new connections with commonly encountered stimuli.

10.Question

In what way did the public health campaign about soda leverage triggers effectively compared to other campaigns?

Answer:The campaign highlighted the harmful effects of soda consumption by integrating it into the context of

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drinking soda itself, making the message relevant at the exact moment consumers were likely to encounter sugary drinks.

Chapter3 | Emotion| Q&A

1.Question

What emotional response is most effective in driving people to share content, according to the chapter?

Answer:Awe is the most effective emotional response in driving people to share content. Awe evokes a sense of wonder and amazement, motivating individuals to convey their experience to others.

2.Question

How can the emotions of users impact the sharing of online content?

Answer:Users are more likely to share online content if it evokes high-arousal emotions such as awe, excitement, and anger, which drive them to take action. In contrast, low-arousal emotions like sadness can decrease the likelihood of sharing.

3.Question

What role does physiological arousal play in promoting

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the sharing of content?

Answer:Physiological arousal boosts sharing behavior. Both emotional and physical arousal lead individuals to share information more freely, as seen in experiments where participants who engaged in physical activity were more likely to share articles.

4.Question

Why did Denise Grady's article about the science of coughing go viral?

Answer:Denise Grady's article went viral primarily because it evoked emotions, particularly awe. The stunning visual capture of a cough and its implications in understanding airborne diseases sparked interest and prompted readers to share it widely.

5.Question

How does negative emotion influence sharing according to the research presented?

Answer:Interestingly, while sadness decreases sharing, negative emotions such as anger and anxiety can actually

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increase sharing. They evoke physiological responses that encourage individuals to express their feelings and share their concerns with others.

6.Question

What is the significance of high-arousal emotions in viral marketing?

Answer:High-arousal emotions are significant in viral marketing because they lead to increased sharing. Marketers should focus on evoking excitement or anger rather than sadness to maximize the chances of content being shared.

7.Question

Can the timing of ads influence their effectiveness in generating shares?

Answer:Yes, the timing of ads can influence their effectiveness. Ads placed during high-arousal moments in television shows are more likely to be shared because viewers are already in an emotionally charged state.

8.Question

How did the Google 'Parisian Love' campaign emotionally engage viewers?

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Answer:The 'Parisian Love' campaign engaged viewers by telling a story of love through Google searches, creating a narrative that resonates emotionally, thereby encouraging viewers to connect with the brand and share the content.

9.Question

What lesson can marketers learn about evoking feelings through their campaigns?

Answer:Marketers should prioritize evoking feelings over merely presenting facts. By focusing on emotions that inspire action, such as excitement and anger, they can create more engaging and shareable content.

10.Question

How does understanding the types of arousal help in creating effective marketing messages?

Answer:Understanding the types of arousal helps marketers craft messages that elicit the right emotional responses. By focusing on high-arousal emotions, marketers can create content that is more likely to be shared, discussed, and acted upon.

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Chapter4 | Public| Q&A

1.Question

What can we learn from Steve Jobs' decision to flip the Apple logo for better visibility?

Answer:Jobs recognized the importance of observability in branding and user experience. By flipping the logo, it became visible to onlookers when the computer was opened, enhancing public visibility and encouraging others to imitate the behavior of Apple users. This decision illustrates that visibility can amplify brand recognition and influence consumer behavior.

2.Question

How do people make decisions about where to eat in an unfamiliar city?

Answer:People often rely on social proof; they look for crowded restaurants assuming that if many people are eating there, it must be good. This tendency to follow the crowd reflects a broader human behavior of imitating those around

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us to inform personal choices.

3.Question

What is 'social proof' and how does it affect behavior?

Answer:Social proof is the psychological phenomenon where individuals look to the actions of others to determine what is acceptable or advisable. It influences behavior in both trivial choices, like dining selection, and significant decisions, such as health choices and lifestyle changes.

4.Question

Can you give an example of how social proof can lead to poor decisions?

Answer:When waiting for a kidney transplant, individuals are less likely to accept a kidney if they see that many others have refused it. This creates a false impression about the quality of the organ, leading to rejection of potentially viable options due to the influence of others' decisions.

5.Question

How did the Movember Foundation leverage social proof to increase awareness and donations?

Answer:Movember made the private act of supporting men's

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health issues public by encouraging men to grow mustaches in November. The visual presence of these mustaches prompted conversations and awareness, ultimately leading to a significant increase in donations for prostate cancer research.

6.Question

What was the impact of the 'I Voted' sticker on voter turnout?

Answer:The 'I Voted' sticker made the private act of voting observable, reminding people of the social norm to participate in elections. It created visual evidence that others were voting, which encouraged more individuals to vote, thereby enhancing overall turnout.

7.Question

Why did anti-drug commercials have the opposite of their intended effect?

Answer:Anti-drug ads increased drug use among teens by making drug use more observable. Instead of discouraging the behavior, they inadvertently communicated social proof

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that many peers were using drugs, thus making it seem more acceptable.

8.Question

How can behavioral residue effectively promote a brand or cause?

Answer:Behavioral residue refers to the physical traces left by behaviors. Items like the Livestrong wristband serve as a constant reminder of support for a cause, facilitating ongoing conversations and visibility that promote the brand even when the item is not actively in use.

9.Question

In what way can product design enhance observability?

Answer:Product design can enhance observability by making the products more visible when used in public. For example, brightly colored items or logos, such as Apple's white headphones, become social signals that can influence others' preferences and purchasing decisions.

10.Question

What lesson can be drawn from the observation regarding investissements in different careers in an MBA

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program?

Answer:The convergence of career choices among students during their MBA program illustrates the power of social influence. Individuals often align their aspirations with those of their peers, driven by the visibility of popular paths, which reaffirms the idea that behavior is shaped significantly by observable social norms.

Chapter5 | Practical Value| Q&A

1.Question

What inspired widespread sharing of Ken's corn video?

Answer:Ken's corn video resonated with people because it provided practical value—an easy and efficient method to clean ears of corn, which many could find useful. Moreover, the video's appeal transcended demographic boundaries, especially intriguing a demographic often overlooked by viral content: seniors. This highlights that practical and useful information is highly valued and shared to benefit others.

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2.Question

Why might hikers discuss vacuum cleaners instead of nature?

Answer:The hikers' conversation about vacuum cleaners illustrates a deeper point about human nature: people love sharing practical, useful information. Even in a serene environment, the desire to exchange useful knowledge about household items proves that practicality can drive conversation, regardless of the setting.

3.Question

How does practical value drive sharing?

Answer:Practical value drives sharing because people inherently want to help others by passing along useful information that can save time or money or improve experiences. This altruism reflects the desire for community support, akin to historical barn raisings where communities collaboratively assist one another.

4.Question

What psychological principles explain why people perceive discounts differently?

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Answer:People evaluate discounts relative to a reference point, leading to differing perceptions of value based on the starting price. For instance, a significant discount off a high-priced item might seem more appealing than a smaller discount off a lower-priced item due to this psychological anchoring effect.

5.Question

Why do promotions seem more valuable when they are scarce?

Answer:Scarcity heightens perceived value because limited availability creates a sense of urgency and desirability. Just as exclusive deals feel special, promotions that seem rare are often shared more widely, as they appear to offer a significant, unique benefit.

6.Question

How does the 'Rule of 100' affect promotional strategies?

Answer:The 'Rule of 100' dictates that for products below $100, percentage discounts seem more attractive, while absolute dollar discounts become more appealing for items

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over $100. This insight helps marketers present deals more effectively, ensuring they resonate with consumer perceptions.

7.Question

What is the takeaway regarding sharing practical information?

Answer:The overarching message is that people love to help one another through the sharing of practical information. This intrinsic desire to be useful drives the sharing of content, making it crucial for communicators to emphasize practical value in their messages.

8.Question

How do marketers make useful information more visible?

Answer:Marketers can enhance the visibility of practical information by showcasing savings prominently at checkout or sharing results openly, such as displaying total savings to encourage more consumers to engage and pass along the information.

9.Question

What broader implications does this chapter suggest

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about consumer behavior?

Answer:This chapter emphasizes that practical value, rooted in human altruism, influences consumer behavior significantly. Understanding this concept can empower businesses to craft strategies that promote sharing and increase the perceived value, ultimately driving engagement and sales.

10.Question

Reflect on the story of the Trojan Horse about information sharing.

Answer:The Trojan Horse symbolizes how effective communication and the strategic sharing of information can lead to unprecedented outcomes. Just like the Greeks succeeded through clever planning and subterfuge, sharing valuable, practical information can create significant impacts and drive consumer behaviors.

Chapter6 | Stories| Q&A

1.Question

What lesson can we learn from the story of the Trojan

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Horse about communication?

Answer:The Trojan Horse teaches us that stories are powerful vessels for delivering messages. By embedding information within engaging narratives, we capture people's attention and make the lesson more memorable.

2.Question

Why do people prefer stories over simple facts?

Answer:People think in terms of narratives, which have structure and emotional engagement. Stories stick in our memories better than dry facts because they create a connection and are easier to recall.

3.Question

How did storytelling serve the ancient Greeks in the absence of modern entertainment?

Answer:In ancient Greece, storytelling was the primary form of entertainment, providing not only amusement but also a means to share cultural information, morals, and social values in a compelling way.

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4.Question

What are some reasons why people share personal stories?

Answer:People share stories for social currency (to appear cool), emotion (to evoke feelings), and practical value (to provide useful information). This sharing often includes narratives about personal experiences.

5.Question

What is the significance of the moral in classic tales like 'The Three Little Pigs'?

Answer:The moral conveys essential life lessons in an engaging way, showing that hard work and perseverance lead to better outcomes, allowing the story to teach while entertaining.

6.Question

How do stories facilitate cultural learning?

Answer:Stories help us understand societal standards and norms without costly trial and error. They provide relatable examples, making it easier for individuals to navigate social expectations.

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7.Question

Why do narratives carry more weight than advertisements in influencing consumer trust?

Answer:Personal experiences shared in stories are harder to dispute than the claims made in advertisements, making them more persuasive. We connect with them on an emotional level.

8.Question

How does Dove’s 'Evolution' campaign use storytelling effectively?

Answer:Dove's 'Evolution' tells a powerful story about beauty standards, allowing the brand to engage in a meaningful conversation without overtly selling its products. It addresses societal issues while promoting brand values.

9.Question

What makes a story beneficial for branding beyond just going viral?

Answer:A story is valuable for branding when it integrates key information about the product into the narrative, allowing the brand to be a natural part of the conversation,

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rather than an afterthought.

10.Question

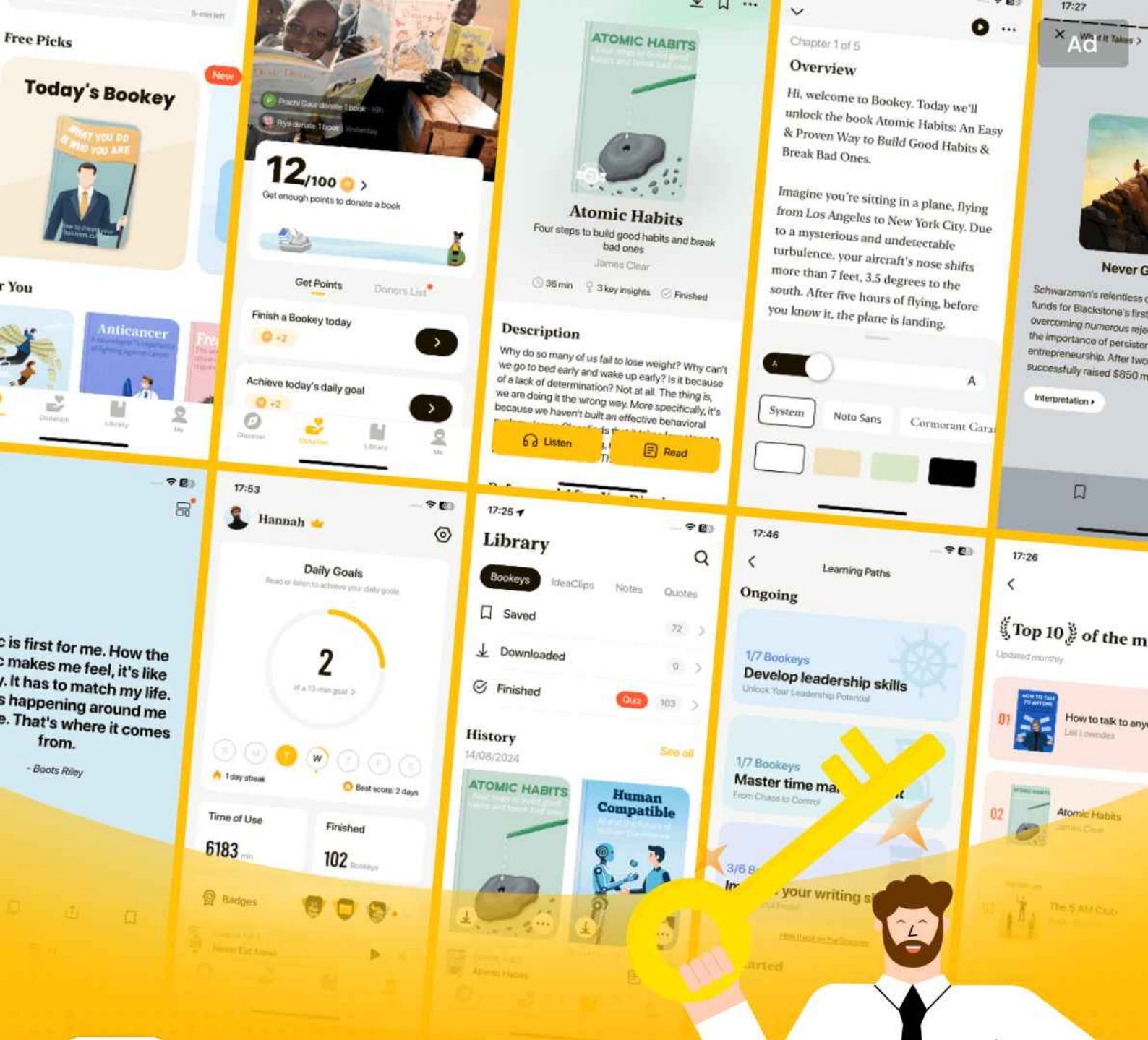
What key takeaway can marketers learn about creating content?

Answer:Marketers should focus on creating narratives that embed their product messaging deeply into the plot, ensuring that the information is crucial to the story itself, enhancing both engagement and brand recall.

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Contagious Quiz and Test

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Chapter1 | Social Currency| Quiz and Test

1. The unique entrance of Please Don't Tell was created by transforming a 1930s phone booth.
2. Companies should avoid making their products seem exclusive in order to enhance desirability.
3. Scarcity and exclusivity increase emotional attachments to products, encouraging customers to share their experiences.

Chapter2 | Triggers| Quiz and Test

1. Triggers are environmental cues that enhance the likelihood of products being discussed, even if the products aren't particularly interesting.
2. Immediate word-of-mouth refers only to conversations that happen weeks after a relevant event occurs.
3. Consistent stimuli, such as regular reminders, can contribute to the viral success of a product or idea.

Chapter3 | Emotion| Quiz and Test

1. Emotional resonance increases the likelihood of

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sharing content.

2.Sadness is a powerful emotion that drives sharing behavior.

3.Awe is characterized by feelings of disappointment and despair.

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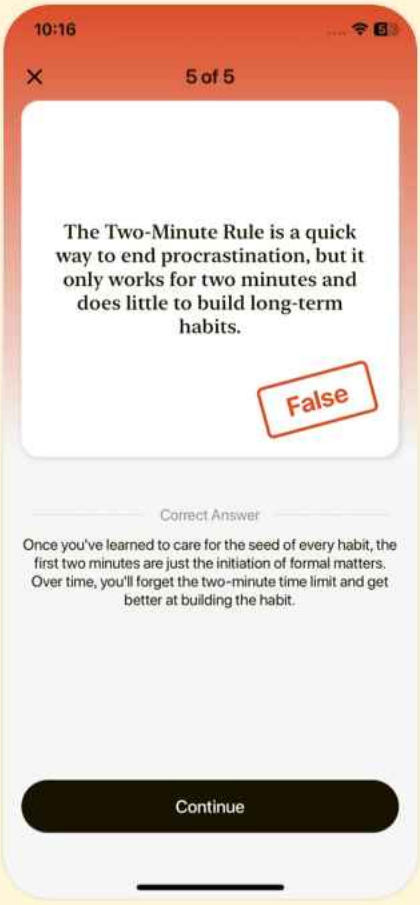
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Chapter4 | Public| Quiz and Test

1. Steve Jobs changed the orientation of the Apple logo on laptops to enhance branding visibility.
2. The desire to imitate others is based on the assumption that individuals have unique information that is better than what others possess.
3. Making private behaviors public can sometimes lead to increased engagement and participation in social issues.

Chapter5 | Practical Value| Quiz and Test

1. People enjoy sharing practical, useful information as it offers 'news others can use'.
2. According to Berger, consumers prioritize savings on more expensive products over lower-priced items.
3. Making savings and discounts visible to shoppers can help generate buzz around promotions.

Chapter6 | Stories| Quiz and Test

1. The Trojan Horse story teaches us that trust can be deceiving and we should be cautious of seemingly friendly intentions.

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2.In ancient times, stories like the Trojan Horse were primarily used for factual education rather than entertainment.

3.To promote a brand effectively, stories should only focus on entertainment without embedding any important messages or lessons.

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